

Call 3 — Introductory call with a prospective client

Anonymised call transcript

Anonymised and condensed. Speakers are labelled by role. Mostly relationship-building; little workflow content in the retrievable portion, which covers roughly the first half of the call.

Ylookup	What are the main things you are working on at the moment?
Prospect	We recently went through a large reorganisation, so a lot of new direct reports now report into me. I have effectively taken over the entire engineering function, which is around fifty to sixty people, on top of my existing team. As you can imagine there is a lot of anxiety associated with that kind of change, so I am trying to manage it.
Ylookup	That is quite a change from running your own startup.
Prospect	Absolutely. The good thing about a startup is that it is all about the product — you live or die by it. In a large enterprise the product and the delivery are only a small portion of your day. It is much more about strategy, positioning, thinking about processes and mapping things out, and that can be tiring.
Prospect	What I loved about running my own company was that you focus on everything — engineering, hiring, marketing, product, setting the vision. Right now it is much more about grinding through admin.
Prospect	On the positive side, we have transformed the organisation a great deal in about eighteen months. This was a company that did not know what a container was. Now we have a full suite — infrastructure as code, CI/CD pipelines, agentic coding, and a few genuinely good projects rolled out across the firm. And a rock-solid team.